INFO 102 Introduction to Information Systems - Syllabus

College of Computing and Informatics, Drexel University

Course Information

Term: 2025-2026 Summer
Course Location: Online
Schedule: Asynchronous Class

Instructor

Instructor: Aria Pessianzadeh
(ap3943@drexel.edu)

Office Hours: To be surveyed and by appointment

Contacting the Instructor

Email is the preferred method of communication. Ensure your email has a subject line that references the course, such as "INFO 102 Question." Emails without a clear subject line may be mistaken for spam.

Catalog Course Description

This course introduces students to the major types of information systems, their development, and use in organizations. It highlights how information systems can assist individuals and organizations in achieving their objectives, assuming a basic understanding of computing concepts.

Curriculum Role

The course is mandatory for BSIS, BSCST, and BSDS students, typically taken at the start of the freshman year. It is also available as an elective for various other majors.

Course Rationale

The course establishes a foundational understanding of information system concepts and terminology.

Course Outcomes

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

- Discuss basic functions of major organizational information systems.
- Explain the use of these systems in organizations.
- Describe the life cycles of information system development.

- Address the impact of social media and ethics on information

Prerequisite

None

Textbooks

P. Wallace, Introduction to Information Systems, 5th Edition, 2023. ISBN 978-0-13582984-4.

Course Work

The course consists of 5 components:

- Readings and Class Discussion: Weekly readings indicated on Blackboard, including supplementary materials. Participation is graded on attendance and contribution to discussions.
- Discussion Board Participation: Graded based on written contributions to 4 discussion threads on Blackboard.
- Exams: Two open book exams with multiple choice and true/false questions. The Midterm covers Weeks 1-4 and the Final covers Weeks 6-9.
- Homework: Two assignments.
- Term Project: Comprising of: a. An initial project proposal. b. A PowerPoint presentation. c. A 1200-word paper.

Tentative Schedule

The schedule is subject to change depending on the class's knowledge base. Below is the initial schedule for the term.

Week	Topics	Reading	Tasks
1	Introduction to Information Systems	Chapter 1	
2	Organizational Strategy and Information Systems	Chapter 2	DB1
3	Databases and Data Management	Chapters 4, 9	HW1
4	Social Computing, Mobile Computing and e-Commerce	Chapters 6, 8	DB2
5	User-centered Design	Readings	Midterms
6	Information Ethics, Privacy and Assurance	Chapter 10	DB3, Term Project Proposal
7	Systems Development in the Enterprise	Chapters 5, 11	HW2
8	Business Intelligence and Decision Making, Strategic Planning	Chapters 7, 12	DB4
9	Slide Presentation	Monday, May 25 Wednesday, May 27	No class (Memorial Day) Term Project Presentation
10	Term Project Final Report	Monday, June 1 Wednesday, June 3	Term Project Presentation Final Examinations
11	Finals Week	June 8, 2026 Monday 11:59 pm	Term Project Final Report

Note DB1, DB2, DB3, and DB4 are four topics to discuss on the discussion board.

Grading

The course grade is based on participation, homework, discussion board, exams, and the course project, calculated as follows:

Task	Weight	Due
Course participation / Attendance	10%	Weeks 1-10 (Live)
Discussion Board	20% (5% each)	Weeks 2, 4, 6, 8 Part 1 – every Thursday 11:59PM Part 2 – every Sunday 11:59PM
Homework 1	10%	Week 3 (Sunday 11:59PM)
Midterm	15%	Week 5
Term project proposal	5%	Week 6 (Sunday 11:59PM)
Homework 2	10%	Week 7 (Sunday 11:59PM)
Term project presentation	5%	Week 9 & 10 Class Sessions
Final Exam	15%	Week 10, Finals Week
Term project final report	10%	Week 11 (June 8, Monday @ 11:59PM)

Work is graded on a scale from 0 to 100, considering both content and form. A single grade is assigned based on these factors.

Grade Conversion

Points	Grade
>=99	A+
93-98	A
90-92	A-
87-89	B+
83-86	B
80-82	B-
77-79	C+
73-76	C
70-72	C-
67-69	D+
63-66	D
<=62	F

Class Participation (10 points)

Students must read the assigned materials before each lecture and are expected to participate in class discussions. Most lectures involve discussions led by the instructor based on weekly subjects.

Written Exams (30 points)

The course includes one midterm written exam and one final written exam. Tentatively, the midterm is in week 5 and the final exam is in finals week. Specific dates and formats will be announced in class. Exams are individual effort and must be taken and accomplished alone. Disability accommodations are honored.

Term Project (20 points)

The course has a term project comprising of: a). An initial project proposal due in week 6, b). A project slide show presentation due in week 8, and c). A 1200- word paper due at the end of the course or Week 10. Each student must work alone to complete the three parts of the final project.

Discussion Board Assignments (20 points)

There are 4 weekly Discussion Board assignments throughout the term, each worth 5%. They consist of two parts:

> Part 1 Share: 2.5 pts - Complete a short assignment related to the week's topics and post it for classmates.
> Part 2 Discuss: 2.5 pts - Read and respond to classmates' posts.

Instructions and grading rubrics will be provided on Monday of the relevant week. Part 1 is due by 11 59 pm on Thursday, and Part 2 by 11 59 pm on the following Sunday.

Homework (20 points)

There are 2 homeworks for this course due in weeks of 3 and 7. Instructions and grading rubrics will be provided on Friday prior to the relevant week or submission week. Homeworks are individual effort and must be completed alone.

Submitting Assignments

- Assignments must be submitted via Blackboard Learn by 11 59 pm on the due date, with all submitter names, student IDs, course number, and assignment number on the first page.
- University rules on academic honesty are strictly enforced.

Late or Missing Work

- Late Work: There will be a 10% deduction per day for late submissions, up to a maximum of 3 days. After that, assignments will not be accepted.
- Missing Work: Will receive a zero grade.

Re-Marking

Re-marking requests must be in writing, explaining why the grade is considered incorrect. Note that grade changes rarely affect the final letter grade significantly. For grade appeals, university policies apply.

Academic Honesty

Strict adherence to Drexel University's Academic Honesty Rules and Procedures is expected. Plagiarism or cheating may result in an F grade.

To avoid plagiarism:

- Ensure individual work is original.
- Attribute sources properly in papers, using quotations or paraphrasing with citations.
- **Append a signed academic honesty statement to deliverables.**

Academic Honesty Statement

I certify that my work in this course will be entirely my own. I will not quote others without proper citation and will not submit this work for any other course requirements.

Name/Signature_____
Date _____

Responsible Use of AI

The use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools (e.g., generative AI systems such as ChatGPT or similar technologies) is permitted **only as a support tool** for learning, and must be used responsibly, transparently, and ethically. Acceptable uses may include brainstorming ideas, clarifying concepts, or assisting with grammar and organization. However, AI tools must not be used to generate complete assignments, responses, or projects that are submitted as the student's own work without proper acknowledgment.

If AI tools are used in any capacity, students must:

- Clearly disclose the use of AI in their submission (e.g., in a footnote or acknowledgment section)

- Describe how the AI tool contributed to the work (e.g., in a footnote or acknowledgment section)
- Ensure that all final content reflects their own understanding and critical thinking

The following uses are strictly prohibited:

- Submitting AI-generated work as one's own without disclosure
- Using AI tools during exams or assessments unless explicitly authorized
- Relying on AI to bypass learning objectives or demonstrate competencies dishonestly

Violations of this policy will be treated as breaches of academic integrity and will be handled in accordance with Drexel University's academic misconduct procedures.

Students are encouraged to approach AI as a learning aid—not a substitute for intellectual engagement—and to use these tools in ways that support their academic and professional development.
https://drexel.edu/~/media/Files/provost/policies/PO-103-Appendix-A.ashx#:~:text=Full%20AI%20Generated-,Content%20Creation,outlined%20in%20their%20course%20syllabus

Class Attendance and Participation

Regular attendance and participation are crucial. Failure to attend classes may result in a failing grade. See university policy on attendance.

Disabilities

Students with disabilities should contact the Office of Disability Services for accommodation.
https://drexel.edu/disability-resources/support-accommodations/student-family-resources/accommodations

Withdrawal from the Course

Refer to university policies for course drop and withdrawal. https://drexel.edu/provost/policies-calendars/policies/course-add-drop/
https://drexel.edu/provost/policies-calendars/policies/course-coop-withdrawal/

Class Cancellation

If an instructor is absent without notice, class is cancelled after 15 minutes.
https://drexel.edu/provost/policies-calendars/policies/cancellation_instructor_absence/

Class Lecture Recording

Lectures may be recorded for educational use only.

Incomplete Policy

Incomplete grades are at the instructor's discretion and require completion of 90% of coursework and an incomplete contract.
https://drexel.edu/provost/policiescalendars/policies/incomplete_grades_undergraduate/

Support for Equality and Diversity

Drexel is committed to providing an environment free of discrimination. Contact the Office of Equality and Diversity for related issues. https://drexel.edu/equity-inclusive-culture

Student Conduct and Community Standards

Students are expected to behave responsibly. University conduct standards are available online.
https://drexel.edu/studentlife/community-standards/code-of-conduct

Strategies for Success

Attend classes, complete readings and assignments punctually, and take thorough notes for the written exams.

Course Evaluation

Feedback is solicited via AEFIS and is confidential.

Syllabus Changes

The instructor reserves the right to make changes to the syllabus as needed.

Notice: Appropriate Use of Course Materials

Course materials are intellectual property and are subject to Drexel University policies. Unauthorized use may result in academic dishonesty charges.